It would behove the policy process to be sceptical about the solutions that are hawked in three-page notes, to be slow and cautious. We should set a high bar on the minimum level of knowledge and evidence required before embarking upon even a modest intervention into the lives of private people.

Example 25: The bankruptcy reform

Parliament enacted the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC) in May 2016. There was a great rush in quickly getting the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India up and running, and in declaring the IBC open for business. Many corners were cut in getting to a quick launch.

By early 2019, we have seen many difficulties in the working of the IBC. The big cases have proved stubbornly hard to process. Consider an alternative history. Would it have made sense to lay the groundwork from May 2016 to May 2018, and only then declare the IBC open for business? We suspect that things would have looked better by early 2019, if that slow path had been taken.

Example 26: The Rhine was not cleaned in a day

In 1986, a blast at the Sandoz chemical plant in Basel, Switzerland, leaked tonnes of toxic chemicals in the Rhine, Europe's longest river. The 1233-km-long transboundary river, passes through Switzerland, Liechtenstein, Austria, Germany, France and Holland. This presented complex multi-nation problems of policy coordination, in order to clean the river.

In 1987, the Rhine Action Plan was drawn up, with a simple and bold target: *By the year 2000, there would be salmon in the Rhine again*. The implementation plan employed a variety of measures and instruments to clean the river—from expanding and equipping biological sewage treatment plants, to working with non-profits like Greenpeace to monitor emissions levels, and industrial regulation and enforcement. While the original plan